



*A man-of-war's
tentacles can sting
you even after
it is dead.*

Man-of-war

Don't touch! They might look like strings of brightly coloured beads, but these are stinging tentacles. They belong to the Portuguese man-of-war. Each arm can be 10 m (33 ft) long and they are loaded with powerful venom, which can kill. The man-of-war looks like a big jellyfish; however, it is another type of sea creature called a siphonophore (sigh-fon-oh-four). A siphonophore is a collection of many animals sharing the same body. Each animal has a different job. Some catch prey, while others digest food or help the body float. They work together, yet none have a brain. They drift together on the ocean, wherever the wind and waves take them.